

Automation Opportunity Assessment

Use this template to assess whether a candidate process or workflow is a good automation opportunity. Map the work. Measure the pain. Automate with purpose.

Value

Is this worth solving?

Feasibility

Can this be automated?

Readiness

Is the process ready?

How to Use This Template

This assessment is designed to produce a clear, evidence-based recommendation about what should happen next — not a full business case or technical design.

O1 Summarise the process or opportunity Provide a short description of the workflow or activity being assessed.	O2 Capture known pain points and evidence Record what is painful, slow, risky, inconsistent or frustrating.	O3 Assess across three lenses Score the opportunity on value, feasibility and readiness.
O4 Identify risks and gaps Note assumptions, dependencies and missing evidence.	O5 Select a category and agree next action Choose the opportunity category and record the recommended next step.	

 Update this assessment as new evidence becomes available. It is a living record, not a one-time exercise.

1. Opportunity Overview

Complete the fields below to establish the context for this assessment. All fields should be filled before the assessment is shared or reviewed.

Opportunity name	[OPPORTUNITY NAME]
Related process	[PROCESS NAME]
Date assessed	[DATE]
Assessed by	[NAME / TEAM]
Process owner	[PROCESS OWNER]
Business area / team	[TEAM]
Related canvas / notes	[LINK OR REFERENCE]
Assessment status	Draft / In review / Confirmed / Updated

2. Short Description

Describe the opportunity in one or two sentences.

[Briefly describe the process, workflow or activity being assessed. What does it do, who does it, and why does it matter?]

3. Problem / Pain Statement

Describe the main pain point in plain language. What is painful, slow, risky, inconsistent, manual or frustrating about the process?

[What is painful, slow, risky, inconsistent, manual or frustrating about the process?]

Pain Type

Select the main type of pain. More than one may apply.

Effort

Too much manual work, repeated activity or low-value effort

Flow

Delay, waiting, bottlenecks, handoffs or poor visibility

Quality

Errors, rework, missing information or inconsistent outputs

Risk

Compliance, control, security, audit or operational risk

User Impact

Poor experience, frustration, chasing or reduced productivity

Cost

Avoidable cost, duplication or inefficient use of resources

4. Known Evidence

Capture the evidence currently available. Estimates are acceptable — mark them clearly and record the confidence level.

Evidence / Metric	Value or Estimate	Source	Confidence	Notes
Volume	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Cycle time	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Touch time	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Wait time	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Manual effort	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Handoffs	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Rework / errors	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Exceptions	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Risk impact	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
User impact	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]

Evidence Summary

[What does the evidence currently suggest? Summarise the key signals and note any significant gaps.]

5. Proposed Response

What kind of response appears most appropriate based on the evidence? Select all that apply.

- Automation
 - Process improvement
 - Automation and process improvement
 - Standardisation
 - Policy / rule clarification
- Data quality improvement
 - Workflow visibility / reporting
 - Further technical investigation
 - Defer for now
 - Other — [DESCRIBE]

Response Summary

[Explain why this response appears appropriate based on the evidence gathered so far.]

6. Value Assessment

Value asks: is this worth solving? Consider whether the opportunity could reduce effort, delay, rework, risk, cost or poor experience.

Value Question	Assessment
How often does this process happen?	[RESPONSE]
How much effort does it currently take?	[RESPONSE]
Where does it create delay or wait time?	[RESPONSE]
Where does it create rework or errors?	[RESPONSE]
What risk could be reduced?	[RESPONSE]
Who would benefit if this improved?	[RESPONSE]
What would improve if this was automated or redesigned?	[RESPONSE]
Is the value measurable?	Yes / No / Partially / Unknown

Value Score

Select one: **High / Medium / Low / Unknown**

Value Rationale

[Explain the value score. What evidence supports this rating?
What is still uncertain?]

7. Feasibility Assessment

Feasibility asks: can this be automated? Consider whether the process has clear rules, stable inputs, accessible systems and a realistic technical pathway.

Feasibility Question	Assessment
Are the steps reasonably clear?	[RESPONSE]
Are the rules or decision criteria clear?	[RESPONSE]
Are inputs and outputs stable?	[RESPONSE]
Is the data structured and accessible?	[RESPONSE]
Are the systems accessible through workflow, API, export, integration or automation tooling?	[RESPONSE]
Are exceptions manageable?	[RESPONSE]
Are there security, compliance or governance constraints?	[RESPONSE]
Is there a likely technical pathway?	Yes / No / Partially / Unknown

Feasibility Score

Select one: **High** / **Medium** / **Low** / **Unknown**

Feasibility Rationale

[Explain the feasibility score. What makes this technically achievable or challenging?]

8. Readiness Assessment

Readiness asks: is the process ready? Consider whether the process has ownership, stability, stakeholder support and enough clarity to move forward.

Readiness Question	Assessment
Is there a clear process owner?	[RESPONSE]
Is the current process understood?	[RESPONSE]
Is the process stable enough to automate or improve?	[RESPONSE]
Are the normal path and exceptions understood?	[RESPONSE]
Are stakeholders aligned on the problem?	[RESPONSE]
Are decision rules or approvals agreed?	[RESPONSE]
Is there support to change the process?	[RESPONSE]
Are there dependencies that must be resolved first?	[RESPONSE]

Readiness Score

Select one: **High** / **Medium** / **Low** / **Unknown**

Readiness Rationale

[Explain the readiness score. What would need to change for this to be ready?]

9. Summary Assessment

Summarise the assessment across the three lenses and provide an overall view of the opportunity.

Lens	Score	Rationale
Value	High / Medium / Low / Unknown	[RATIONALE]
Feasibility	High / Medium / Low / Unknown	[RATIONALE]
Readiness	High / Medium / Low / Unknown	[RATIONALE]

Overall Assessment Summary

[Summarise the overall assessment in a few sentences. What does the combined picture suggest? What are the key strengths and concerns?]

10. Opportunity Category

Select the category that best describes the opportunity based on the three-lens assessment.

**Automate Now**

High value, feasible and ready

Move into automation discovery or design

**Improve First**

Worth solving, but process needs tidying

Clarify, simplify, standardise or assign ownership

**Investigate Further**

Potential value, but more evidence is needed

Gather data or assess technical feasibility

**Do Not Automate Yet**

Low value, unstable or unclear

Defer or address underlying process issues

Selected Category

☐ Automate now ☐ Improve first ☐ Investigate further ☐ Do not automate yet

Category Rationale

[Explain why this category was selected. Reference the value, feasibility and readiness scores.]

11. Candidate Opportunity Breakdown

If the process has multiple possible opportunities, break them down here. Use this table to compare sub-opportunities and prioritise where to focus.

Opportunity	Type	Value	Feasibility	Readiness	Suggested Category	Notes
[OPPORTUNITY]	Automation / improvement / both / investigation	H / M / L	H / M / L	H / M / L	[CATEGORY]	[NOTES]
[OPPORTUNITY]	Automation / improvement / both / investigation	H / M / L	H / M / L	H / M / L	[CATEGORY]	[NOTES]
[OPPORTUNITY]	Automation / improvement / both / investigation	H / M / L	H / M / L	H / M / L	[CATEGORY]	[NOTES]

❏ Example breakdown: "Improve request form" → Process improvement → Improve first. "Add approval reminders" → Workflow automation → Automate now. "Automate standard provisioning" → System automation → Investigate further.

12. Risks, Assumptions and Dependencies

Risks

Risk	Impact	Mitigation / Action
[RISK]	High / Medium / Low	[MITIGATION]
[RISK]	High / Medium / Low	[MITIGATION]

Dependencies

Dependency	Owner	Notes
[DEPENDENCY]	[OWNER]	[NOTES]
[DEPENDENCY]	[OWNER]	[NOTES]

Assumptions

Assumption	How to Validate
[ASSUMPTION]	[VALIDATION ACTION]
[ASSUMPTION]	[VALIDATION ACTION]

13. Missing Evidence and Validation Actions

Capture what needs to be gathered before the opportunity can move forward. Assign an owner and due date for each item.

Missing Evidence / Validation Need	Why It Matters	Source / Who Can Help	Owner	Due Date
[MISSING EVIDENCE]	[WHY IT MATTERS]	[SOURCE / PERSON]	[OWNER]	[DATE]
[MISSING EVIDENCE]	[WHY IT MATTERS]	[SOURCE / PERSON]	[OWNER]	[DATE]
[MISSING EVIDENCE]	[WHY IT MATTERS]	[SOURCE / PERSON]	[OWNER]	[DATE]

14. Recommendation

✔

Recommendation Statement

[Recommended decision: automate now / improve first / investigate further / do not automate yet.]

Why

[Explain why this recommendation makes sense based on value, feasibility, readiness and evidence. Be specific about the key factors that drove the decision.]

What Should Happen Next

[Describe the next best action. Who should do what, by when, and what outcome is expected?]

15. Next Best Action

Capture the immediate next action clearly. Each action should have a named owner and a due date.

Action	Owner	Due Date	Status	Notes
[NEXT ACTION]	[OWNER]	[DATE]	New / In progress / Done	[NOTES]
[NEXT ACTION]	[OWNER]	[DATE]	New / In progress / Done	[NOTES]

16. Decision Record

Use this section to record decisions or updates about the opportunity over time. Add a new row each time a significant decision is made or the assessment is updated.

Date	Decision / Update	Decision-maker / Owner	Notes
[DATE]	[DECISION OR UPDATE]	[OWNER]	[NOTES]
[DATE]	[DECISION OR UPDATE]	[OWNER]	[NOTES]

17. Assessment Summary

Use this section as a short executive-style summary. Complete this last, once all other sections are filled in.

Opportunity	[OPPORTUNITY NAME]
Main pain	[SUMMARY]
Known evidence	[SUMMARY]
Value	High / Medium / Low / Unknown
Feasibility	High / Medium / Low / Unknown
Readiness	High / Medium / Low / Unknown
Category	Automate now / Improve first / Investigate further / Do not automate yet
Recommendation	[SUMMARY]
Next best action	[SUMMARY]

A good automation candidate is not just technically possible.

It should be valuable enough to prioritise, feasible enough to automate, and ready enough to change. If an opportunity is not ready for automation, it may still be worth improving.

Map the work. Measure the pain. Automate with purpose.